

Word family: **want / wants / wanted / wanting**

Base word: want

Third-person singular: wants

Past tense / past participle: wanted

ing form: wanting

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun in specific uses (特定名詞用法) / adjective in lexicalized uses (詞彙化形容詞用法)

Useful constructions/extensions: want something, want to do something, want someone to do something, want something done, what do you want?, all I want is..., wanted person, wanted poster, wants and needs, for want of, be wanting in

Your passage contains:

> “I **want to learn from her while I can**.”

Here, **want** means:

to have a strong desire or wish to do something.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **want to learn from her**

you have a personal desire to:

- * spend time with your grandmother;
- * absorb her experience;
- * learn from her values;
- * understand her way of handling life.

Nobody is forcing you.

It is something you **personally wish to do**.

Meaning: To desire or wish to do something.

繁體中文: **想要 ; 希望做某事 ; 有做某事的意願 / 願望**

中文翻譯:

> “I want to learn from her while I can.”

「趁現在還有機會，我**想多向她學習**。」

So:

want to do something = 想要 / 想做某事

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. **want something (想要某物) — 想要；希望得到**

The basic core meaning.

Meaning: To desire to have, get, or receive something.

Practice 1

> “I **want some water**.”

「我**想要一些水**。」

Practice 2

> “She wants a new phone.”

「她**想要一部新手機**。」

want + noun = 希望得到 / 擁有某物

2. **want to do something (想做某事) — 想；希望**

This is the exact construction used in your passage.

Practice 3 — Original

> “I **want to learn from her** while I can.”

「趁現在還有機會，我**想向她學習**。」

Practice 4

> “I **want to visit** her this weekend.”

「我這個週末**想去探望她**。」

Practice 5

> “She wants to spend more time with her family.”

「她**想花更多時間陪伴家人**。」

want to + verb = 有做某項行動的願望 / 意圖

3. **want someone to do something (想要某人做某事) — 希望某人做**

A major construction.

Practice 6

> “I **want you to listen** carefully.”

「我**希望你仔細聽**。」

Practice 7

> “She wants her children to be happy.”

「她**希望孩子們快樂**。」

want + person + to + verb = 希望某人進行某項行動 / 處於某種狀態

4. **want someone not to do something (希望某人不要做) — 不想某人.....**

Practice 8

> “I **don’t want you to worry**.”

「我**不想你擔心**。」

Practice 9

> “She didn’t want him to leave.”

「她**不想他離開**。」

not want someone to do = 希望某人不要進行某項行動

5. **want something to happen (希望某事發生) — 希望 ; 想要**

Practice 10

> “I **want things to improve**.”

「我**希望情況改善**。」

Practice 11

> “They want the project to succeed.”

「他們**希望項目成功**。」

want + thing + to + verb = 希望某個情況 / 結果出現

6. **want something done (希望某事被完成) — 要求 / 希望處理好**

A major construction.

Practice 12

> “I **want this finished today**.”

「我**希望這件事今天完成**。」

Practice 13

> “She wants the room cleaned before the guests arrive.”

「她**希望客人到之前把房間清理好**。」

want + object + past participle = 希望 / 要求某件事情被處理到指定狀態

Depending on tone, this can sound stronger than a simple wish.

7. **want = strongly desire a particular result (想得到某結果) — 渴望 ; 希望**

Practice 14

> “Everyone **wants success**.”

「每個人都**渴望成功**。」

Practice 15

> “What she really wants is peace.”

「她真正**想要的是平靜**。」

want = 對某種結果 / 狀態具有明確願望

8. **all I want is... (我只想要.....) — 唯一想要的是**

A common emphatic construction.

Practice 16

> “**All I want is some quiet**.”

「我**只想要一點安靜**。」

Practice 17

> “All she wants is to spend time with her family.”

「她**只想多陪家人**。」

all someone wants = 強調某個願望是最主要 / 唯一要求

9. **what do you want? (你想要甚麼 ?) — 想要甚麼 / 有甚麼要求**

Practice 18

> “What do you **want** for dinner?”

「你晚餐**想吃甚麼**？」

Practice 19

> “What do you want from me?”

「你到底**想要我怎樣 / 想從我這裡得到甚麼**？」

what do you want? = 詢問某人的願望、選擇或要求

Tone can make it neutral, impatient, or confrontational.

10. **want = prefer / choose in service situations (要 ; 選) — 想要 ; 要**

Very common in ordering and choosing.

Practice 20

> “Do you **want tea or coffee**?”

「你**要茶還是咖啡**？」

Practice 21

> “I want the smaller one.”

「我**要較小的那個**。」

want = 在幾個選項中表示自己希望選擇 / 取得哪一個

11. **want = desire someone romantically/sexually (對某人有強烈吸引 / 慾望) — 想得到某人**

A genuine but context-sensitive sense.

Practice 22

> “It was obvious that he **wanted her**.”

「很明顯，他對她有**強烈的情感 / 性吸引**。」

Practice 23

> “She knew he still wanted her.”

「她知道他仍然**對她有強烈的愛慕 / 慾望**。」

want someone = 某些成人 / 浪漫語境中，表示對某人有強烈情感或性吸引

Context is essential because:

> “I want you to help”

does **not** carry this meaning.

12. **want = need / require attention (需要 ; 該.....了) — 需要處理**

A separate established use, especially in British English and somewhat old-fashioned/formal in some contexts.

Practice 24

> “The car **wants washing**.”

「這輛車**該洗了 / 需要清洗**。」

Practice 25

> “This room wants cleaning.”

「這個房間**需要清潔了**。」

want + -ing = 某物需要接受某種處理

Modern learners can usually use:

> **needs cleaning**

instead.

13. **want = lack / be without (缺少) — 缺乏**

An older/formal sense, now mainly surviving in fixed expressions.

Practice 26

> “The plan failed **for want of** money.”

「計劃因**缺乏資金**而失敗。」

Practice 27

> “The project stopped for want of support.”

「項目因**缺乏支持**而停止。」

want = lack / absence ; 缺少某項必要事物

Bare **want** with this meaning is no longer a normal everyday learner use, but the fixed expression **for want of** remains useful.

14. **for want of something (因缺乏.....) — 因欠缺 ; 因沒有**

A major surviving fixed expression from the “lack” sense.

Practice 28

> “The plants died **for want of** water.”

「植物因**缺水**而枯死。」

Practice 29

> “The idea was abandoned for want of funding.”

「這個構思因**缺乏資金**而被放棄。」

for want of X = 因為欠缺 X

Formal.

15. **want = noun: lack / shortage (缺乏 ; 匱乏) — 欠缺 ; 貧困**

A formal/literary noun sense.

Practice 30

> “Many families suffered **want** during the crisis.”

「危機期間很多家庭陷入**匱乏 / 貧困**。」

Practice 31

> “They lived in poverty and want.”

「他們生活在**貧窮和匱乏**之中。」

****want = 缺乏生活必需品，尤其物質 / 金錢不足****

This is formal/literary and lower priority for active use.

16. ****wants = things someone desires (想要的東西) — 欲望；需求****

A useful plural noun.

Practice 32

> “People have different ****wants and needs****.”

「人有不同的****欲望和需要****。」

Practice 33

> “The product is designed around customer wants.”

「這件產品按顧客的****需求 / 想要的東西****設計。」

****wants = 人想得到但未必是生存 / 功能上必需的東西****

Often contrasted with:

> ****needs****.

17. ****wants and needs (想要與需要) — 欲望與需要****

Practice 34

> “Children gradually learn the difference between ****wants and needs****.”

「孩子逐漸學會分辨****想要的東西和真正需要的東西****。」

Practice 35

> “Budgeting requires separating wants from needs.”

「做預算時，需要區分**非必要欲望和實際需要**。」

want = something desired

need = something necessary

This is one of the most important conceptual contrasts.

18. **wanted = being sought (被通緝 / 被尋找的) — 被通緝；有人要找**

A genuinely separate lexicalized adjective.

Practice 36

> “He is **wanted by the police**.”

「警方正在**通緝他**。」

Practice 37

> “The suspect is wanted for questioning.”

「警方正在**尋找這名疑犯以進行問話**。」

wanted = 某人正被警方 / 某組織積極尋找

This is not the ordinary past tense meaning “想要過.”

19. **wanted person / wanted poster (通緝犯 / 通緝海報) — 通緝**

Practice 38

> “His face appeared on a **wanted poster**.”

「他的樣貌出現在**通緝海報**上。」

Practice 39

> “The police released information about the wanted man.”

「警方公布了這名**被通緝男子**的資料。」

wanted = 因警方 / 當局希望找到某人而形成的詞彙化形容詞

20. **wanted = desired / welcomed (被需要 / 受歡迎的) — 被想要 ; 受歡迎**

Another adjective use derived directly from the ordinary desire meaning.

Practice 40

> “The child needed to feel **wanted**.”

「那個孩子需要感到自己是**被需要 / 被愛的**。」

Practice 41

> “She finally felt wanted and accepted.”

「她終於感到自己是**被需要、被接納的**。」

feel wanted = 感到別人真正希望你存在 / 需要你、重視你

This is emotionally distinct from:

> wanted by police.

21. **unwanted (不想要的 ; 不需要的) — 不受歡迎 ; 多餘**

A major opposite family form.

Practice 42

> “We received several **unwanted emails**.”

「我們收到幾封**不想收到的電郵**。」

Practice 43

> “She felt unwanted.”

「她覺得自己**不被需要 / 不受歡迎**。」

****unwanted = 沒有人想要、需要或歡迎的****

22. ****wanting = lacking / insufficient (有所欠缺的) — 不足 ; 欠缺****

A genuinely separate formal adjective.

Practice 44

> “His explanation was ****wanting in detail****.”

「他的解釋在細節方面****有所欠缺****。」

Practice 45

> “The report was found wanting.”

「這份報告被認為****有所不足 / 不合要求****。」

****wanting = 缺乏某項必要品質 , 因此不夠好 / 不充分****

Formal.

23. ****be wanting in something (缺乏某品質) — 欠缺 ; 不足****

Practice 46

> “The plan is ****wanting in clarity****.”

「這個計劃在清晰度方面****有所不足****。」

Practice 47

> “His argument was wanting in evidence.”

「他的論點****缺乏證據支持****。」

****be wanting in X = 缺少 X 這項重要品質 / 成分****

Formal.

24. **find something wanting (認為不足) — 認為未達標；有所欠缺**

A fixed formal expression.

Practice 48

> “The committee **found the proposal wanting**.”

「委員會認為這份提案**有所不足 / 未達要求**。」

Practice 49

> “The evidence was found wanting.”

「這些證據被認為**不夠充分**。」

find X wanting = 經評估後認為 X 缺乏必要品質 / 不足以達標

Important distinction: **want vs need**

This is the most important distinction.

want

= desire something.

need

= require something because it is necessary.

Compare:

> “I **want** some tea.”

= 我想喝茶。

> “I **need** water.”

= 我需要水。

Something can be:

> wanted but unnecessary.

Important distinction: **want to vs need to**

want to do

= personal desire.

need to do

= necessity/requirement.

> “I want to visit her.”

= 我想探望她。

> “I need to visit her.”

= 我有必要去探望她。

Your passage uses **want**, so the learning is voluntary and personally meaningful.

Important distinction: **want vs would like**

Both express desire.

want

= direct, everyday.

would like

= softer/more polite.

Compare:

> “I want some tea.”

direct.

> “I’d like some tea.”

more polite in service/social situations.

Important distinction: **want vs wish**

want

= desire something realistically or directly.

wish

often concerns:

- * unreal situations;

- * regrets;

- * formal hopes.

> “I want to see her.”

= genuine present desire.

> “I wish I could see her.”

= suggests an obstacle.

Important distinction: **want vs hope**

want

= what you desire.

hope

= desire combined with belief that something may happen.

> “I want her to recover.”

focuses on desire.

> “I hope she recovers.”

focuses on desired future outcome.

Important distinction: **want vs intend**

want to

= desire.

intend to

= have a plan/purpose.

You can:

> want to travel

without actually intending/planning to travel soon.

Important distinction: **want vs plan**

want

= desire.

plan

= organized intention.

> "I want to visit Japan."

may be only a wish.

> "I plan to visit Japan next year."

indicates actual preparation/intention.

Important distinction: **want vs prefer**

want

= desire one thing.

prefer

= choose one option over another.

> “I want tea.”

= I desire tea.

> “I prefer tea to coffee.”

= tea is my favored option.

Important distinction: **want vs like**

like

= find something enjoyable/pleasant.

want

= desire to have/do it.

You can like something without wanting it now.

> “I like cake, but I don’t want any.”

Perfectly natural.

Important distinction: **want someone to do vs tell someone to do**

want someone to do

= desire that they do it.

tell someone to do

= directly instruct them.

> “I want you to rest.”

expresses desire, though it can sound forceful.

> “I told you to rest.”

reports an instruction.

Different interpersonal force.

Important distinction: **I want you to... — neutral vs forceful**

The structure is grammatically neutral, but tone matters.

> “I want you to be happy.”

warm.

> “I want you to do this now.”

can sound commanding.

So **want** itself is desire, but the construction can pragmatically function like a strong request.

Important distinction: **want something done vs want to do something**

Compare:

> “I want **to clean the room**.”

= I personally want to clean it.

versus:

> “I want **the room cleaned**.”

= I want the room to end up clean; someone else may do it.

Important grammatical distinction.

Important distinction: **want = desire vs want = need**

Compare:

> "I want the car."

= I desire the car.

versus the less common British-style:

> "The car wants washing."

= the car needs washing.

The second is a special construction and should not be generalized too widely.

Important distinction: **wanted = desired vs wanted = sought by police**

Compare:

> "She wanted the job."

Here:

wanted = past tense of desire.

> "He is wanted by police."

Here:

wanted = adjective meaning authorities are searching for him.

Same form, completely different function.

Important distinction: **feel wanted vs be wanted by police**

feel wanted

= feel valued, loved, needed.

be wanted by police

= be sought by law enforcement.

A huge semantic difference despite identical spelling.

Important distinction: **wanted vs welcome**

wanted

= desired / someone wants your presence.

welcome

= gladly accepted/received.

> "I felt wanted."

= I felt people genuinely wanted me there.

> "I felt welcome."

= I felt people received me warmly.

Closely related but not identical.

Important distinction: **unwanted vs unnecessary**

unwanted

= not desired.

unnecessary

= not needed.

An item may be:

> unnecessary but wanted,

or:

> necessary but unwanted.

This mirrors the crucial:

> want vs need

contrast.

Important distinction: **wants vs needs**

wants

= things people desire.

needs

= things required for functioning, well-being, or a specific purpose.

In consumer/business language:

> customer wants

may be preferences.

> customer needs

are more fundamental requirements.

Important distinction: **wanting vs wanting to**

This is a major grammar trap.

wanting to leave

Here:

> wanting

is the -ing form of **want**:

= 想離開。

But:

> “The report is wanting.”

Here:

> ****wanting****

is an adjective:

= 有所不足.

Same form, radically different meaning.

Important distinction: **wanting vs lacking**

**wanting**

= lacking an important quality; formal.

**lacking**

= more neutral/direct.

> “The report is wanting in detail.”

formal.

> “The report lacks detail.”

more natural everyday/professional English.

Important distinction: **for want of vs because there wasn't enough**

**for want of money**

= because of lack of money.

This is formal/literary.

Everyday English would more naturally say:

> “because there wasn't enough money”

or:

> “because of a lack of funding.”

Family-extension sweep

The practical **want** family is built around desire, but has several important lexicalized extensions:

- * **want something** = 想要某物
- * **want to do** = 想做某事
- * **want someone to do** = 希望某人做某事
- * **not want someone to do** = 不希望某人做
- * **want something to happen** = 希望某事發生
- * **want something done** = 希望 / 要求某事被完成
- * **all I want is...** = 我唯一想要的是.....
- * **want — choice/order** = 要 / 選擇
- * **want someone — romantic/sexual** = 對某人有強烈愛慕 / 慾望
- * **want + -ing — need** = 需要被處理 (較英式 / 較少用)
- * **for want of** = 因缺乏.....
- * **want — noun: lack** = 匱乏 / 缺少 (正式)
- * **wants** = 想要的東西 / 欲望
- * **wants and needs** = 欲望與需要
- * **wanted — sought** = 被通緝 / 被尋找的
- * **wanted — desired** = 被需要 / 被想要的
- * **unwanted** = 不想要 / 不受歡迎的
- * **wanting — deficient** = 有所欠缺的
- * **be wanting in** = 缺乏某品質
- * **find X wanting** = 認為 X 不足 / 未達標

The main semantic branches are:

- > **desire to have something**
- > **desire to do something**
- > **desire another person/result to act or occur**
- > **need/require in limited constructions**
- > **lack/absence in formal uses**

plus lexicalized family meanings:

- > **wanted = sought**
- > **wanting = deficient**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
want something	對某物有取得、擁有或使用它的願望
want to do	有進行某項行動的個人願望 / 意圖
want someone to do	希望某人進行某項行動 / 處於某狀態
want something to happen	希望某個情況或結果出現
want something done	希望 / 要求某件事情被處理到指定狀態
want — choice/order	在幾個選項中表示自己希望選擇 / 取得哪一個
want someone — romantic	對某人有強烈愛慕 / 性吸引；須依語境判斷
want + -ing — need	某物需要接受某種處理；較常見於部分英式用法
for want of X	因為欠缺 X 而導致某結果
want — noun: lack	缺乏生活必需品 / 物質匱乏；正式或文學用法
wants — desires	人想得到但未必真正必要的東西 / 欲望
wanted — sought	正被警方 / 某組織積極尋找的
wanted — desired	被別人真正希望存在、需要或重視的
unwanted	沒有人想要 / 需要 / 歡迎的
wanting — deficient	缺少重要品質、因此不夠充分 / 未達要求
be wanting in X	在 X 這方面有所欠缺
find X wanting	經評估後認為 X 缺乏必要品質 / 未達標

For your original passage

> “I know that one day these visits will become memories, and I **want to learn from her while I can**.”

The exact meaning is:

want to do = have a desire or wish to perform an action

Therefore:

> **want to learn from her**

= **「想向她學習 / 希望從她身上多學一些東西」**

This word matters because the speaker is expressing a **personal choice and desire**.

Compare:

> **I want to learn from her.**

= 我**想**向她學習。

versus:

> **I need to learn from her.**

= 我**需要 / 有必要**向她學習。

The passage uses **want**, so the emotional meaning is:

> I value her wisdom

> → I personally wish to learn from her

> → and I want to do it before the opportunity disappears.

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **I want some tea.**

> = 我想喝 / 想要一些茶。

> **I want to visit her.**

> = 我想探望她。

> **I want you to listen.**

> = 我希望你聽。

> **I want things to improve.**

> = 我希望情況改善。

> **I want this finished today.**

> = 我希望 / 要求今天完成這件事。

> **wants and needs**

> = 想要的東西與真正需要的東西

> **wanted by the police**

> = 被警方通緝 / 尋找

> **feel wanted**

> = 感到被需要、被重視

> **unwanted attention**

> = 不想要的關注

> **for want of money**

> = 因缺乏資金

> **the report is wanting in detail**

> = 報告在細節方面有所不足

> **the evidence was found wanting**

> = 證據被認為不夠充分

So **want** is much richer than simply:

> **want = 想要**

The key conceptual map is:

****WANT****

→ desire something

→ desire to do something

→ desire another person/result to do/be something

then, in more restricted formal or lexicalized uses:

****WANT****

→ lack / need

****WANTED****

→ desired

→ being searched for

****WANTING****

→ lacking / insufficient

And in your original passage:

****want = “personally desire to learn from her while the opportunity still exists.”****